



AFTER

Although lackluster in the defense of Reconstruction, President Hayes took important steps to reform the "spoils system," which had been a significant source of political corruption.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORM

In June 1877, Hayes issued an **executive order forbidding Federal employees from being involved in party politics**. The next year he put this into effect when he **fired the Republican Chester A. Arthur as collector of customs at the Port of New York**. New York Senator Roscoe Conkling had obtained the lucrative job for Arthur, who was in turn accused of employing staff for party allegiance rather than competence. Ironically, **Arthur, when he became president**, was responsible for key civil service reforms.

THE GREAT RAILROAD STRIKE

Violence returned to the nation in July 1877, when a strike by railroad workers led to widespread riots in several cities. Controversially, Hayes sent in **Federal troops to restore order and protect the railroads**. The strike and its repression left **more than 100 people dead**.